Behavioral Finance in Action: Evidence from Individual Investor Data

By Jen Itzkowitz

Primary Data

From an App-Based Stock Brokerage

- January 2015 – September 2020

Includes

- User information: age, gender, zip code
- Trade Information: buy, sell, stock ticker, date, method of funding, amount

Unique features

- Gift Cards
- Minor Accounts
- Fractional Shares

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Past Projects – with this data

- My Research
  - Start Small and Stay Small: Anchoring in App-Based Investing (link)
  - The Gender Gap in Stock Market Participation: Evidence from Stock Gifting (link)
- Student Research
  - Encouraging Stock Market Participation
    - with Emilia Fedasz and Andy Schwartz
  - Is Trading *Still* Hazardous to your Wealth?
    - with Clil Halevi
  - Local Preference: Familiarity Bias or Informational Advantage?
    - with Sarah Hart and Shen Zhang
  - Sleep disruptions Create Fear in the Market
    - with Aiden Windrem

The Process

- Fall 2026
  - Enroll in Behavioral Finance class
    - Read background papers
    - Learn more about the research process
  - Generate additional research ideas
- Spring 2027
  - Earn course credit – Independent Study
  - Write a paper
  - Present your results at Petersheim Academic Research Exposition